

KIHWAN YU

CONTACT INFORMATION

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural and Environmental Policy, Agricultural Finance, Agricultural Production and Risk Management

EDUCATION

Kansas State University Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics	Kansas, USA 2023–December 2026 (Expected)
Seoul National University M.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics	South Korea 2019
Kangwon National University B.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics and Psychology	South Korea 2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

"The supply of offers and bids in the Conservation Reserve Program"

Kihwan Yu, Nazli Z Uludere Aragon, and Nathan P. Hendricks

Abstract: A central challenge in payments for ecosystem services (PES) is designing mechanisms that procure environmental benefits cost-effectively. While many PES programs use auction mechanisms with reference prices to reduce information rents, existing evidence provides limited guidance on how these prices affect participants' bidding behavior and enrollment decisions. We examine CRP General Signup offers using two sources of exogenous variation generated by administrative policy changes. We find that landowners respond to higher reference prices by offering higher rental rates, but the effects on offered acres are more mixed, suggesting that higher reference prices have limited effects on land-use decisions.

WORKING PAPERS

"Resource-Driven Agricultural Clusters: Coagglomeration Effects of the High Plains Aquifer"

(Second-round revise and resubmit, American Journal of Agricultural Economics)

Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

Abstract: Quantifying the regional economic impacts of crop production is critical for assessing the broader implications of access to natural resources and government policies. However, most existing estimates rely on input-output models with restrictive assumptions and competing theories of economic mechanisms provide little guidance on the sign or magnitude. We estimate local economic spillovers by exploiting a large increase in crop production that occurred due to the expansion of irrigation in counties overlying the High Plains Aquifer after World War II. While crop production was directly impacted by access to groundwater, we find that livestock product sales also increased significantly, reaching a 235% increase in sales compared to counties outside the aquifer. The primary spillover to non-farm sectors was an increase in sales in the wholesale sector, perhaps driven by sales of agricultural-related products. These findings provide evidence of coagglomeration incentives, where clusters of agricultural industries find it optimal to produce within the same region.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Risk Aggregation and Insurance Demand: An Analysis of Enterprise Unit Discounts"

Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

PUBLICATIONS

Kim, Y. J., Jung, J., Yu, K., Kim, S., and Olynk Widmar, N. 2024. Spatial differentiation in food service pricing: an explorative study with web-scraped data. *International Food and Agribusiness Management Review*, 27(3), 566-592.

(Journal Articles in Korean)

K. Yu, D. Jeong, and K. Kim. 2021. "Estimating the Effects of Donation Tax Reduction on Farmland Using a Generalized Propensity Score Approach". *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics* 62(1): 1-21.

K. Yu, and K. Kim. 2019. "An Estimation of Welfare Effects of Minimum Wage Increase in an Agricultural Production Sector Using a Stochastic Equilibrium Displacement Model". *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics* 60(2): 1-21.

AWARDS

Outstanding Article Award, Korean Agricultural Economics Association	2022
Third Place Award, Paper Competition, Korean Rural Development Administration	2018
Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, Kangwon National University	2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Independent Instructor, Kansas State University

AGEC 115 Decision Tools for Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness	Fall 2024
Average Evaluation: 4.6/5.0	

Workshop Instructor, Kansas State University

Introductory R Workshop for Incoming Students	2026, 2025
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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Kansas State University	2023–Present
Researcher, Korea Rural Economic Institute	2020-2022
- Developed and published commodity price outlook dashboards based on retail scanner data - Managed R-based web-scraping workflows	
Researcher, Seoul National University	2019
Graduate Research Assistant, Seoul National University	2017-2018

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Annual Conference of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), New Orleans, LA.	2024
Annual Conference of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Washington, DC.	2023
Annual Conference of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual.	2021
Annual Conference of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual.	2020
Annual Conference of North American Regional Science Council (NARSC), Pittsburgh, PA.	2019

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Academic Advisor for Undergraduate Students	2016
President, Food System Research Society	2015
Student Social Committee Member, Agricultural Economics	2014

REFERENCES

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